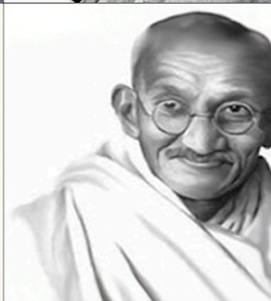


General Knowledge

Modern History

STUDY NOTES

**Indian National Congress
Sessions**



INC SESSIONS

Introduction

The Indian National Congress (INC) was established in 1885, serving as a pivotal institution in India's freedom struggle and shaping its political landscape pre- and post-independence. The formation of the INC was preceded by various socio-political movements that highlighted the need for an organized platform to represent Indian interests under British colonial rule.

Background and Foundation of the Indian National Congress

The idea of an all-India organization was conceived by educated Indians who wished to channel nationalist sentiment and address pressing issues. However, it was **A.O. Hume**, a retired British civil servant, who took concrete steps toward this idea. Hume's involvement is often considered an effort to create a **"safety valve"** for growing discontent among Indians, aiming to contain the potential for rebellion by giving educated Indians a platform for dialogue and reform. The first session was held in Bombay (now Mumbai) on **December 28, 1885**, at **Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College**. **Originally intended for Poona, the venue changed due to a cholera outbreak.**

ONE OF THE FOUNDERS OF THE INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS AND A CIVIL SERVANT,
ALLAN OCTAVIAN HUME WAS BORN ON JUNE 6, 1829

FATHER OF THE INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS

A leading spirit behind the founding of the Indian National Congress, he wanted to provide Indians a **democratic, representational government**

Was **one of the convenors of the first session of the INC** at Bombay in 1885 & served as **GENERAL SECRETARY** for the first 22 years

He was bold in questioning British policies in India

As an administrator, **introduced free open school education** and a juvenile reformatory in Etawah, Uttar Pradesh

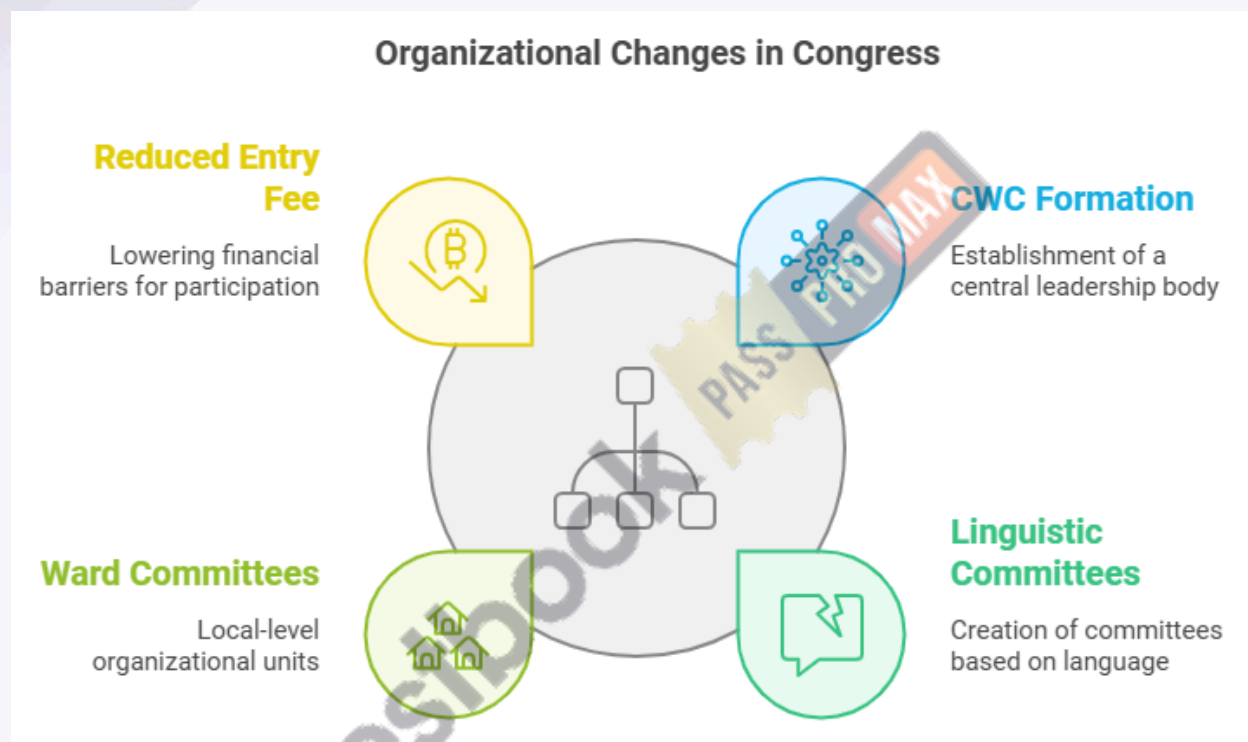


Was also known as 'Father of Ornithology' due to his keen interest in birds

Objectives of the Indian National Congress

At the inaugural session, W.C. Bonnerjee, the first president of the INC, outlined its objectives:

1. **Fostering personal intimacy and friendship** among Indians from different regions.
2. **Eliminating prejudices** related to race, creed, and region.
3. **Promoting national unity** by consolidating nationalist sentiments.
4. **Recording and addressing the opinions** of educated Indians on important issues.
5. **Establishing an action plan** for issues of public interest.



Participation and Representation

The INC primarily attracted Western-educated professionals, notably lawyers, who became instrumental in articulating the nationalist agenda. Aristocrats like Rajas, Maharajas, Zamindars, and wealthy merchants were initially reluctant to join, as they viewed the Congress's liberal and nationalist ideas as potentially threatening to their positions. Similarly, peasants and artisans were underrepresented, as the early Congress did not fully address rural issues and labor rights.

Sessions



THE FIRST INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS, 1885.

Place	Year	President	Key Outcomes
Bombay	1885	Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee	The first session was attended by 72 delegates The objectives of Congress outlined
Calcutta	1886	Shri Dadabhai Naoroji	Merger of National Congress and National Conference Decision to set up Provincial Congress Committees
Madras	1887	Badriddin Tyabji	Appeal to Muslims to join hands with national leaders First Muslim president
Allahabad	1888	George Yule	George Yule became the first English President of INC.
Bombay	1889	Sir William Wedderburn	-
Calcutta	1890	Pherozeshah Mehta	-
Nagpur	1891	P. Ananda Charlu	-

Allahabad	1892	Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee	The Indian Councils Act of 1892 introduced by the British government was criticized by the Congress on the ground
Lahore	1893	Shri Dadabhai Naoroji	-
Madras	1894	Alfred Webb	-
Pune	1895	Surendranath Banerjee	-
Calcutta	1896	Rahimatullah M. Sayani	Vande Mataram' sung for the first time by Rabindranath Tagore
Amravati	1897	C. Sankaran Nair	Congress slammed Bal Gangadhar Tilak's arrest on charges of sedition.
Madras	1898	Ananda Mohan Bose	-
Lucknow	1899	Romesh Chunder Dutt	Demand to stop the 'drain of wealth' to England Call for permanent fixation of land revenue
Lahore	1900	N.G. Chandavarkar	-
Calcutta	1901	Dinshaw Eduljee Wacha	Mahatma Gandhi appeared on the Congress platform Urged support against racial discrimination and exploitation
Ahmedabad	1902	Surendranath Banerjee	-
Madras	1903	Lal Mohan Ghosh	-
Bombay	1904	Sir Henry Cotton	Congress protested against Lord Curzon as he violated the rules by using the Indian revenue for his forward policy in Tibet
Banaras	1905	Gopal Krishna Gokhale	Expressed resentment over Bengal's partition Supported Swadeshi movement
Calcutta	1906	Shri Dadabhai Naoroji	First mention of 'Swaraj' Supported Swadeshi, boycott, and national education programs
Surat	1907	Rash Behari Ghosh	Known as "Surat Split" Division between moderates and extremists within Congress
Madras	1908	Rash Behari Ghosh	Congress constitution formulated

Lahore	1909	Madan Mohan Malaviya	Disapproval of separate electorates introduced in Morley-Minto reforms
Allahabad	1910	Sir William Wedderburn	-
Calcutta	1911	Bishan Narayan Dar	Jana Gana Mana' sung for the first time
Bankipore	1912	Shri Raghunath Narasinha Mudholkar	-
Karachi	1913	Nawab Syed Mohammed Bahadur	Lucknow Pact signed with the Muslim League Reunion of moderates and extremist
Madras	1914	Bhupendra Nath Bose	-
Bombay	1915	Satyendra Prasanna Sinha	-
Lucknow	1916	Ambica Charan Mazumdar	The moderates and extremists were united and extremists were readmitted into the INC in the Lucknow session. Also, Congress signed the Lucknow Pact with the Muslim League.
Calcutta	1917	Annie Besant	First woman president of Congress
Delhi	1918	Madan Mohan Malaviya	Congress commented that the Montague-Chelmsford reforms are disappointing and demanded a Declaration of Rights for the people of India.
Bombay (Special)	1918	Syed Hasan Imam	Condemnation of Jallianwala Bagh massacre Demand for Declaration of Rights for Indians
Amritsar	1919	Motilal Nehru	Support for Khilafat Movement Strong condemnation of the Jallianwala Bagh massacre
Calcutta (Special)	1920	Lala Lajpat Rai	Approval of non-cooperation program Included boycott of schools, foreign goods, and councils
Nagpur	1920	C. Vijayaraghavachariar	Shifted goal to Swaraj through peaceful means Introduced organizational changes
Ahmedabad	1921	Hakim Ajmal Khan (Acting for C.R. Das)	Harsat Mohani demanded complete independence.
Gaya	1922	Deshbandhu Chittaranjan Das	Formation of Swaraj Party Set up Congress Working Committee (CWC)

Delhi (Special)	1923	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad	-
Belgaum	1924	M.K. Gandhi	Only session presided over by Mahatma Gandhi
Cawnpore	1925	Mrs. Sarojini Naidu	Sarojini Naidu became the first Indian woman to preside over Congress
Guwahati	1926	S. Srinivasa Iyengar	-
Madras	1927	M.A. Ansari	Resolved to boycott Simon Commission Declared complete national independence as Congress's goal
Calcutta	1928	Motilal Nehru	Congress warned the British that a civil disobedience movement would commence if India was not granted dominion status by December 31, 1929 Formation of All India Youth Congress
Lahore	1929	Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru	Declared complete independence (Purna Swaraj) as Congress's goal Authorized civil disobedience January 26, 1930, set as the first Independence Day
Karachi	1931	Vallabhbhai J. Patel	Adopted resolutions on Fundamental Rights and the National Economic Program Condemned execution of Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, and Rajguru
Calcutta	1933	Mrs. Nellie Sengupta	-
Bombay	1934	Dr. Rajendra Prasad	Congress constitution amended Made khadi wearing mandatory for elective members Reduced AICC representation
Lucknow	1936	Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru	Nehru urged Congress to adopt socialism as its goal
Faizpur	1937	Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru	The main theme focused on the economic and social upliftment of the Indian people The resolution approved demanding full independence from British rule
Haripura	1938	Subhash Chandra Bose	Extended support to agitation in princely states Established National Planning Committee

Tripuri	1939	Subhash Chandra Bose	Bose resigned as president due to health and conflicts with the Working Committee Formed Forward Bloc
Ramgarh	1940	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad	Planned civil disobedience movement Reiterated demand for complete independence
Meerut	1946	J.B. Kripalani	The last session before the independence Acceptance of the Cabinet Mission Plan Decision to participate in the Constituent Assembly Formation of the National Planning Committee

Important Congress Sessions

● Bombay Session (1885)

President: W.C. Bonnerjee

Objectives:

- To create a platform for civic and political dialogue among educated Indians.
- Discuss political reforms and establish communication between Indian leaders and the British Government.

Significance: Laid the foundation for an organized political movement in India.

● Benaras Session (1905)

President: Gopal Krishna Gokhale

Objectives:

- Expressed resentment against the Partition of Bengal.
- Proclaimed the **Swadeshi Movement** in Bengal.

● Calcutta Session (1906)

President: Dadabhai Naoroji

Objectives:

- Declaration of **Swaraj (self-rule)** as the goal of the Congress.
- Support for the Swadeshi Movement, boycott of British goods, and promotion of indigenous industries.

Significance: First instance where the concept of self-rule was officially adopted.

● **Surat Split (1907)**

Location: Surat

President: Rash Behari Ghosh

Objectives:

- The session was intended to resolve differences between Moderates and Extremists.
- Significance:
- Marked a major **split within Congress**
- Moderates wanted reforms within the framework of British rule.
- Extremists (led by Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal, and Lala Lajpat Rai) advocated for Swaraj.

● **Lucknow Session (1916)**

President: Ambika Charan Mazumdar

Objectives:

- **Reunion of Moderates and Extremists** within Congress.
- Alliance between Congress and the **Muslim League (Lucknow Pact)**.

Significance: Strengthened Hindu-Muslim unity and made the demand for self-rule more inclusive.

● **Nagpur Session (1920)**

President: C. Vijayaraghavachariar

Objectives:

- Ratification of the Non-Cooperation Movement under Gandhi's leadership.
- Shift from the goal of attainment of self-government through constitutional means to the attainment of swaraj through peaceful and legitimate means.
- Important organisational changes:
 - **Congress Working Committee (CWC)** of 15 members was set up to lead the Congress.
 - Provincial congress committees on a linguistic basis were organised.
 - Ward committees was organized and the entry fee was reduced to four annas.

Significance: Congress transformed into a mass movement with participation from all sections of society.

● **Lahore Session (1929)**

President: Jawaharlal Nehru

Objectives:

- Declaration of **Purna Swaraj (Complete Independence)** as the goal of the Congress.
- The decision to observe **26th January 1930** as Independence Day.
- The Round Table Conference was to be boycotted.

Significance: A milestone that paved the way for the Civil Disobedience Movement.

● **Karachi Session (1931)**

President: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

Objectives:

- Endorsement of the Gandhi-Irwin Pact.
- The goal of **Purna Swaraj** was **reiterated**.
- Adoption of a resolution on **Fundamental Rights and Economic Programme**, which included:
 - Rights to free speech, association, and press.
 - Equal rights for all irrespective of caste, creed, or religion.
 - Protection of workers and peasants.

Significance: Laid the foundation for the socio-economic agenda of independent India.

● **Tripuri Session (1939)**

President: Subhash Chandra Bose (later replaced by Rajendra Prasad)

Objectives:

- Bose faced significant opposition due to his more radical approach to achieving independence.
- Due to health issues and lack of cooperation from the Congress Working Committee (CWC), Subhash Chandra Bose resigned from the presidency after this session.
- Following his resignation, Rajendra Prasad was elected as President of the INC.
- Bose went on to form the Forward Bloc within the Congress, intending to mobilize a stronger revolutionary movement against British rule.

- **Meerut Session (1946)**

President: J.B. Kripalani

Objectives:

- Recognized as the last session of the INC before independence.
- Focused on preparing for the challenges of governance in a soon-to-be independent India.
- It addressed issues related to partition, communal harmony, and the formation of a constitution for independent India.

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